

A FOCUSED MANAGER-EFFECTIVENESS SPRINT

Corework Manager Effectiveness Program

For a performance problem you need to solve now.

Sometimes the issue is not that managers need a general management curriculum. The organization already has managers in seat. They may be experienced. They may have received training before. But something important is still not working consistently.

Accountability is weak. Decisions are bottlenecked. Delegation is poor. Performance conversations happen too late. Teams struggle with competing priorities. Managers are not coaching effectively. A new strategy or operating model requires managers to behave differently, but execution is uneven.

Corework focuses the engagement on one defined manager-performance challenge, then helps managers practice what needs to change against real work while surfacing the conditions that may be helping or constraining execution.

Designed For

Organizations asking questions like:

- Why does execution vary so much from manager to manager?
- Why are managers avoiding or delaying difficult performance conversations?
- Why are our managers still acting as bottlenecks?
- Why isn't delegation happening?
- Why aren't managers applying what we've already trained them to do?
- Why are teams struggling to execute a new expectation or way of working?
- Is this actually a manager-skill problem, or is something else getting in the way?

BEST FIT

Managers who are already in role and a current organizational performance problem that leadership wants to address quickly.

NOT PRIMARILY FOR

Foundational new-manager development. Corework Leadership Pathway Level I serves that need.

10–15	2 Weeks	4 × 2 hr	1 Issue
MANAGERS PER COHORT	SPRINT LENGTH	LIVE COHORT SESSIONS	DEFINED PROBLEM IN FOCUS

How It Works

The client problem changes. The Corework methodology does not.

Start With a Rapid Manager Context Scan

Before the sprint begins, Corework conducts a focused discovery process to understand the presenting problem and the conditions surrounding it. This is not a full organizational diagnostic. It is a narrow scan designed to answer one question:

What do these managers need to do differently to address this problem, and what conditions should we understand before asking them to do it?

The scan may include:

- A 60–90 minute sponsor conversation
- A short manager pulse
- A small number of targeted stakeholder conversations
- Review of selected relevant documents or existing data
- Identification of the manager behaviors, decisions, or practices most critical to the problem

The Corework Manager Effectiveness Method

01

Diagnose & Focus

Make the performance problem concrete. What is happening now? Where does performance break? What do managers need to do differently? The Context Scan establishes the initial hypothesis, and the first cohort session sharpens it against managers' lived experience.

02

Practice & Adjust

Build and practice the skills, tools, and decision habits most relevant to the problem. Managers apply them immediately in their actual work. The cohort then examines what happened, what worked, what did not, and what needs to change.

03

Solve the Hard Cases

Move beyond the easy examples. Participants work through situations where the desired behavior is hardest to apply, such as competing priorities, resistant employees, unclear decision authority, or workload constraints. This is where Corework distinguishes a capability problem managers can address from an operating condition the organization may need to address.

04

Sustain & Transfer

Determine what needs to continue after the sprint. What should managers keep doing? What tools or routines should become normal practice? Where is reinforcement needed? Corework then synthesizes what was learned for the sponsor.

What Client Participation Looks Like

- A sponsor who can define the presenting problem and participate in the Context Scan
- Access to selected documents, existing data, and a small number of relevant stakeholders when useful
- 10–15 managers who attend four live sessions and apply the work between sessions
- A sponsor conversation at the end to review findings and recommended next steps

What the Organization Gets

- Rapid Manager Context Scan
- Focused problem definition
- Four facilitated live cohort sessions
- Practical tools and job aids tied to the identified problem
- Real-work application between sessions
- Manager Effectiveness Insight Readout with recommended actions for the sponsor

The Manager Effectiveness Insight Readout

The engagement ends with more than a training recap. Corework synthesizes what we heard going in, what we observed during the sprint, what appears developmental, what may be structural, and what leadership should consider next.

What We Heard Going In The presenting issue and initial assumptions.	What We Observed Patterns from discussion, practice, and real-work application.
What Appears Developmental Skills and practices managers themselves can strengthen.	What May Be Structural Conditions outside individual manager skill that leadership may need to address.

Scope note: *The Insight Readout is not a full organizational diagnosis. Its conclusions are limited to the evidence available through the engagement. If the sprint surfaces a broader pattern involving decision rights, incentives, capability definitions, ownership, or other parts of the workforce system, Corework may recommend deeper diagnostic work.*

Customized Does Not Mean Built From Scratch

Corework uses a growing library of manager-effectiveness tools, exercises, practices, and capability modules that can be assembled around the issue revealed through discovery. This allows the intervention to respond to the client without turning every engagement into a completely bespoke curriculum-development project.

- Accountability, follow-through, and performance conversations
- Delegation, decision authority, escalation, and judgment
- Coaching, role clarity, and team communication
- Prioritization, competing demands, and cross-functional execution
- Change adoption and manager routines

The Corework Difference

Organizations often assume that an effectiveness problem requires more training. Sometimes managers already know what good management looks like, but unclear authority, conflicting expectations, workload, incentives, tools, or leadership behavior make the desired practice difficult to sustain.

The result: stronger manager practice and a clearer view of what managers can strengthen directly, what may be getting in their way, and what leadership should address next.

Engagement Details

10–15 MANAGERS PER COHORT	2 Weeks SPRINT LENGTH	4 × 2 hr LIVE COHORT SESSIONS	1 Issue DEFINED PROBLEM IN FOCUS
------------------------------	--------------------------	----------------------------------	-------------------------------------

Delivery and Investment

OPTION	WHAT'S INCLUDED	INVESTMENT
Private Virtual	10–15 managers from one organization. Four two-hour virtual sessions delivered over approximately two weeks, plus the Rapid Manager Context Scan.	\$25,000
Private Onsite / Hybrid	Same intervention method delivered onsite or blended. Expanded discovery, additional sessions, multiple populations, or leadership work are scoped separately. Travel expenses, when required, are billed separately at cost.	\$30,000–\$35,000

Examples of What a Sprint May Focus On

The exact skills addressed depend on the problem identified through discovery. The intervention method remains consistent.

Expectations → Feedback → Accountability → Follow-through

Delegation → Decision Authority → Escalation → Ownership

Prioritization → Competing Demands → Team Execution → Operating Cadence

What Is Included

- Context Scan and focused problem definition
- Four live cohort sessions for 10–15 managers
- Relevant tools and job aids
- Real-work application between sessions
- Sponsor Insight Readout and recommended actions

What May Be Scoped Separately

- Expanded discovery
- Additional sessions or manager populations
- Onsite or blended delivery beyond the base scope
- Additional leadership work or deeper workforce-system diagnostic work

Recognize This Problem in Your Organization?

Let's talk about whether a Manager Effectiveness sprint is the right move.

coreworksystems.com | richard@coreworksystems.com | (781) 267-6553